



Appendix A:

Running Lingo & Etiquette

MATERIAL IN THIS SECTION IS WILL NOT BE TESTED ON

❖ RUNNING LINGO

As with most sports or industries, the sport of running has its own lingo that as a coach you need to be familiar with.

5K: Common distance of a running race (3.1 miles)

10K: Common distance of running race (6.2 miles)

13.1: Distance in miles of a half-marathon

26.2: Distance in miles of a marathon

AG: Age Group

Aid Station: Locations that are spaced throughout a race where participants can receive fuel, hydration and first aid

AT: Anaerobic Threshold

Bonk: Also called “hitting the wall”. Occurs when the glycogen stores in the body are empty and the athlete suffers extreme fatigue and the body’s energy source essentially shuts down.

Chip: An electronic chip that tracks the athlete throughout the race

Chute: Sometimes called the “finishing chute”. This is the area directly after the end of the race that athletes funnel into

Corral: Designated areas where runners line up prior to the start of a race. Usually denoted by a runner’s estimated pace

Draft: To run behind another person to save energy

Dropped: If a runner cannot keep up with a group of runners and has been left behind, they have been “dropped”

DNF: Did Not Finish

DNS: Did Not Start

DQ: Disqualified

Fartlek: Type of running workout that integrates random speed changes

Gait: Denotes the form of a runner and in particular, the legs

Half: Half distance marathon (13.1 miles)

HR: Heart rate

HRM: Heart rate monitor

Kick: Used to describe the sprint to the finish line

Leg Turnover: Used to denote the running stride speed (i.e. fast, slow)

LT: Lactate Threshold

Marshall: Individuals on the course to ensure the safety of the participants as well as to ensure all participants follow the rules

Pace: Denotes min/mile rate for a set duration of time or distance

Pack: Group of runners

Pick Ups: Short bursts of speed or accelerations during a run

Plyos: Short for “Plyometrics”, meaning explosive, jumping style movements. Meant to build power

PR: Personal Record (i.e. best time at a specific distance event)

Repeats: A type of interval. Repeated up tempo efforts (typically of the same distance) with a rest period in between

Strides: Short sprints often done prior to, or after a run

Tempo: A steady-state effort often associated with running at a pace close to one's LT.

VO₂: Commonly refers to the “VO₂ Max Test or one's aerobic capacity based on the test

VT: Ventilatory Threshold

Wave: Large running events often combine runners of similar paces in a group, called a ‘wave.’ Waves are often broken down further into ‘corrals.’

❖ RUNNING ETIQUETTE

- During track workouts, if recovering or running slowly, stay to outside lanes
- If getting water or food at aid stations during a race, quickly select items but do not stop in this area. Keep it moving.
- If not getting food or water at aid stations, run on the far left to make room for those that are getting food or water
- At the finish line, do not stop at the line. Keep moving through to not clog up the finish area
- If walking during a race, stay to the far right of the road

GENERAL

- Don't litter
- Do not urinate in public. Use porta-potty's and, or bathrooms allocated by the event for use

- If waiting in line for a porta-potty, allow participants with earlier start times than you ahead of you
- Be on time for group training sessions
- Respect and follow the workout type for group training sessions
- No swearing at event
- Thank the race director, sponsors and volunteers at events
- Cheer on other participants